

The New Nature Brings Perfected Praise

Open to Matthew 21, Hebrews 2, and Psalm 8. I believe the course we will take will be from Matthew to Psalm 8, then from Psalm 8 to Hebrews 2, fluctuating back and forth between those two.

This part is on worship, giving Him the glory, and a little more positional truth about worship as we take another step down the Born-Again Trail.

Before we do, let's pass in review a little bit where we left off, if possible. It is these reviews I get lost in and never come back from.

I have been enjoying worship so much lately, especially corporate worship. Waves and waves of glory pass over my spirit. I can hardly stand it. Like I have told you, sometimes I cannot tell whether you are having church with me or not. It is not that you are not having church; I just cannot tell sometimes.

It used to be I could tell, because I would have church when you had it. He would come, then He would go home, and we would go home. But since He put the worship limb on, He pretty much comes and stays. He is on me so strongly at times that I cannot tell where it stops and begins. I will be having church by myself, look up, and people are looking at me. I think, "I cannot tell anymore. It is okay. Just let me go on with it. I am having a good time."

In understanding this worship limb, now connected with the glory limb, grace, and the love of God, I think when He began putting on this last limb, the glory limb I have been talking about for three or four months, He was taking me into worship because it had everything to do with unveiling God's heart, or His love, to me. I also know that one day I would understand it enough to teach on it.

As worship has begun to open God's love to me, I can understand how dangerous worship is to the devil. It is very, very dangerous to him. I do not know yet if I understand how dangerous, but I am beginning to get glimpses of it.

In Lucifer's creation, God called him the sum total, meaning everything God had created before that was summed up in him, especially his beauty. His beauty, I understand, was absolutely something to behold.

I think his beauty, as he moved through creation, represented God. Everything God was, as far as beauty is concerned, could be seen in him, and it opened creation up to worship. You would just want to worship God, or the Father. Lucifer opened creation up to worship.

Somewhere in the eons of time past, only God can say when, something happened. We do not even know how old Lucifer was before he earned the title Satan. We just know that somewhere back in the history of time, he became exalted in his heart. He wanted to be like the Most High and sit on

the mount of the congregation on the sides of the north. He ascended to some mount that represented being over people and nations, and he wanted to sit there in the place of God.

If he was in charge of opening creation to worship, then somewhere along the line he began to receive that worship for himself. He became exalted in his own heart.

For us to understand how that could happen, we have to remember that creation has a will. We had a will in our creation. I suspect the main reason he wanted to be like the Most High was to receive the worship of creation. I can tell you it must have given him a high that he could get no other way.

I know what happens to men when they begin to receive the glory. I know what happens to men when they receive exaltation. This is why I reinforce it one more time: some things belong to God. All the glory, all the honor, all the praise, all of it, belong to Him.

The world has borrowed the terminology of grace from the expanding knowledge of the Bible. The world uses it: "They have a lot of grace in that area," meaning they have strength there. But grace was a word coined by God in every language to describe all that you and I have as a free gift.

Be very careful to understand that without the freedom of that gifting, without everything being so available and free, we would have nothing. But understand also that because it is so free and such a gift, when you begin to think there is something special about you that caused God to treat you the way He treats you, that He gave you more than someone else, trusted you with more, or gifted you specially because there is just a little something special about you, those little seeds are the beginnings of your fall.

There is no respecter of persons. You must understand, it is impossible for Him to love one of you more than another. It is impossible for Him to give one of you more, as far as who He is and what is available to you. There are differences in callings, but it is impossible for Him to bestow more on one of you because He personally likes you a little more.

Hello, grace. Glory be to God.

So in your worship, remember that some things belong to Him. Your faith will increase when you begin to realize this.

In that seeking time, when He unpeeled the onion skin of the Father's heart and I saw His heart through a thin layer, just a little of it, I walked away from there changed.

When people came up to thank me for different reasons, saying, "The teaching you gave me changed my whole life," I wanted to put my running shoes on. That anointing of His love was fresh on me. The glory limb and His grace were connected with it. I felt like a thief, like a robber trying to take something from God that belonged to Him and receive it to myself.

I wanted to run like a scalded dog.

I knew what they were doing. They were appreciating me, loving me, thanking me for faithfulness and those kinds of things. But in the freshness of that, I wanted to run. I did not want to receive any of it. His grace was so precious and strong.

Hallelujah.

I am finding some kind of balance in there somewhere. But self-exaltation and taking little pieces of the stead of Christ, little pieces of the glory, to yourself is like a drug. You get on it, and it is hard to get off.

We do not know how many millions of years it took Satan to finally say, "I will be like the Most High." He began to divert that worship.

That mountain he took Jesus up on in the temptation, where he showed Him the kingdoms of the world and the glory of them, was connected to the same desire. He said, "Fall down and worship me, and all of it will be Yours."

Isn't it something? After he finished tempting Jesus in the natural realm, "Turn the stones to bread," then in the soul realm by badgering and pushing Him to the limit, the final temptation went for the spirit. He wanted Jesus to get down and worship him.

This worship-receiving, self-exalted maniac wants all the false religions of the world to bow down. He is perverted and will even take second-hand worship. He wants to be worshiped and revered as God.

He is crazy.

He puts human beings through different things: grinding human bones, taking organs, making potions and points of contact. The same devils that witchcraft uses to send those things after you are no different than any other devil that singles you out to destroy you because you are climbing up in God. The ceremonies and sacrifices are points of contact, but they mean nothing to me.

You could grind human bones, make a hut out of them, curse me, and throw witch powder. I already know that devil. It does not make any difference to me. They come after me anyway. You do not have to wave some stick with feathers on it. That does not make any difference. You are the one being deceived.

Satan wants worship. He is after it.

We are talking a little about grace. The way we look at it, we think Satan's rise, rebellion, and fall happened almost in human creation's time span. But no. Jesus saw him fall like lightning from heaven before Adam. He had already fallen when the Garden of Eden took place.

I do not know how long God dealt with him. I do not think God's standard would be different. I do not know how many times or how much mercy God extended. All I know is that he was already cast out of heaven, yet he was free to move in our creation when he approached Adam.

People make up theology and speculate, saying God used him to try our creation or used him for this or that. What I do know is that the next level of incarceration will not leave him free to wander. He will be in the lake of fire with the false prophet. He will not approach creation anymore. God is incarcerating him in stages.

If it had been me, I would have said, "That is it. You messed up. You rebelled against Me." I would have incarcerated him and thrown him into hell so he could never bother anybody or anything again.

But he was still loose. To me, the only reason is that God had to have been trying. He had to have been dealing in mercy.

Does worship mean that much to the devil? Yes. He was the sum total of beauty and creation. God put it into him. He opened creation up to worship. He knew what worship meant to God, and he wanted it.

He wanted to be lifted up. That is what he went after.

If Satan was over worship and knew what it meant to God, then understand this: God loves you. What we call worship is you returning that love on a personal and corporate level. That is what He calls it: you loving Him.

The more time you spend in His presence talking to Him, adoring Him, and loving Him, the more you will see there is something about worship that Satan wanted and failed to receive rightly. He watched God in His place in the universe as Creator. He saw how much God enjoyed creation returning that love and fellowship, and he wanted it for himself.

God enjoys us, His creation, whom He made for fellowship.

Again, we equate worship with a God factor, and that is true. But worship is also you returning what He has already given to you. He loves you.

This is the part I am having trouble with. He uncloaked the tiniest bit of His love, and I am having trouble. Maybe I need to learn Greek. The New Testament was written in a more expressive language, with words, tenses, and meanings. In English we have to use a word and then half the language to describe how we mean that word.

I am having trouble interpreting what has gone off in me. It has translated into more tears than I have ever cried in my life. Good tears. I am seeing that His love also flows in an anointing. What would have taken me a hundred years praying in tongues can seem to flow in an anointing and begin to break people down until they love Him more than anything in the world.

I like anointings like that. I love anointings like that.

I am having a little trouble translating the love He has for us. The devil has indicted God and charged Him falsely with everything under the sun for our suffering, all the way down to unfaithfulness, lack, need, disease, and pain. He has framed God for every bit of it.

In that framing process, religion has coined many of the phrases it uses, like, "God can, but He will not." That is about as far from God's love and who He really is as you can get.

We sit there evaluating situations of lack, pain, disease, a broken relationship, a destroyed marriage, trying to handle all the emotions and crisis. The devil stands there framing God and screaming while God is trying to tell you He loves you. Then we wonder why He cannot get through.

You only have one answer first. The Holy Ghost has been trying to interpret the Word for two thousand years. Thank God He finally reveals a road in.

If you want to understand the mystery of God, the mystery of His love in Jesus Christ, take the road He created into the heart of God when He said praying in tongues would build you up on your most holy faith and edify you. Take it.

Right now I am caught between two things: coming out of the greatest framing job the devil ever did on God's behalf, and now trying to translate His heart as I walk into it a step at a time. It is difficult.

But I do know this: His love comes down to me, and then I get to turn around and send back how it has affected my heart in worship. My expression back to Him as His creation is worship.

I remember how difficult the hours were at first. In respect to where I was walking, God had to retreat to the other side of the bulk of my flesh and camp there. He would come over once in a while, bless me, give me a drink of living water, and then retreat back to the other side of the flesh so I would be aware of where I was really walking.

I would worship through dry spells, and He would come and bless me. "Glory, glory. Here is a drink of living water." Then He would go back, and I would be isolated again where I really was. I would worship and worship and worship until every framing of the devil, every false image he created, everything people had said about my Father that was not true, began to lose its hold.

I did not care what I felt like. I did not care what anybody said. I did not care about anything but what He told me to do, until I finally broke through enough that He got to stay with me longer and longer. Finally my worship began to come up as a sweet-smelling presence in His presence, because He was staying longer all the time.

Hallelujah.

"Do you have any flesh left?"

Ask me. Do not ask anybody around me; ask me. Of course I do. I am also receiving the tools to be delivered from those extra levels of flesh that seem to be acceptable in the Christian community.

Amen.

Isn't He glorious?

Satan got to watch God receive worship. The creatures around the throne worship Him. There is something about God: He is so full of love. How could His creation not have the essence and substance of what He is?

The animal kingdom was not created to be what we see now. When regeneration begins, the lion will graze again and the child will play safely with the snake. Something happened in creation. Animals do not have a spirit, so something happened on the soul level. Animals now kill each other for food and those kinds of things.

When the devil gets his way in cultures, they always gravitate downward. Human sacrifice and cannibalism appear. When he isolates people, devils manifest and possession becomes rampant. It ends not only in human sacrifice, but in eating people. The devil reduces creatures created in God's image to something that crawls below dirt level.

You do not think he rejoices in his hatred for God when he sees something once made in the image of God crawling in the dirt and eating people's brains? It makes me sick to think about serving him even in an outburst of anger.

All God's creation, created after Him, has to carry the element that He is love. He does not merely have love; He is love.

If you want a visual effect close to heaven, look at beautiful arrays of flowers in a garden and walk down those paths. I think that is about as close to heaven as you can get. God said He clothed the lilies, and Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of these. His heart and love went into creation, and when creation gives it back, it comes back in the form of fellowship.

That is what God craves and wants as a Father: fellowship. His love for me is returned in worship.

Hallelujah. Hallelujah.

Do you love Him?

There is unexplored territory in God waiting for you if you want it. My prayer for you is that you do not appease yourself by playing religion.

Thank God for programs, but ask the elder brother of the prodigal son: they will not replace your fellowship with God.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

Programs are supposed to be a function of government. They are there to organize the great expanding move of God, not to replace it or try to cause it. If you have not been trained by God first and the program second, then you are going to be a programmed person programming other people later on.

Let's explore a couple of these verses. You remember we were in the Bible, right?

Hallelujah.

I want you to hang on closely because there are a lot of meditators and lovers of the Word here. If I can get enough over to you, you can take it on in yourself. This is one of those things that holds freedom from this temporary world in it. It is one of those truths that stills your enemies. You have a lot of them: poverty, disease, and others.

If I can get enough over to you for you to take it on in, this truth, when you understand it inside, will still many of your enemies for you.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

Let's begin where Jesus Himself quoted Psalm 8. We will go to Psalm 8 in a moment, so put your finger there. For now, look at Matthew 21:13:

It is written, My house shall be called the house of prayer; but ye have made it a den of thieves.

This is the same time He took a whip and cleansed the temple from the money changers. A Roman coin would not be accepted as a clean offering, so the money changers were there, and I am sure for a little interest they would change your Roman coin into Jewish currency. Those who sold doves for sacrifice were there too. I am sure the convenience of having them right in the temple came with a higher quality sacrifice: "These are specially bred doves for sacrifice. They have never touched anything unclean. That is why we charge a dollar or two more."

He called them thieves. He was highly unhappy with them. To merchandise somebody's hunger for God does not make Him very happy.

Hallelujah.

Verse 14 says:

And the blind and the lame came to him in the temple; and he healed them.

I like how simply it puts that. The blind and the lame came to Him in the temple, and He healed them.

Verse 15 says:

And when the chief priests and scribes saw the wonderful things that he did, and the children crying in the temple, and saying, Hosanna to the son of David; they were sore displeased.

The chief priests and scribes saw the miracles, the healings, the blind and the lame healed. To me, the strangest sight was that the ones who expressed the excitement were the children. The adults were probably afraid. Jesus would go on His way, and where would that leave them?

But the children cried, "Hosanna! Hosanna to the Son of David! Blessed is He who comes in the name of the Lord!"

Verse 16 says:

And said unto him, Hearest thou what these say?
And Jesus saith unto them, Yea; have ye never read,
Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings thou hast perfected praise?

Jesus quoted directly from Psalm 8 to explain what those children were doing.

Go to Psalm 8. Jesus authored this back in the Psalms, so when He quoted it the way He did, we need to notice it.

Psalm 8:1-2 says:

O Lord our Lord, how excellent is thy name in all the earth!
who hast set thy glory above the heavens.
Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings hast thou ordained strength because of thine
enemies,
that thou mightest still the enemy and the avenger.

In Matthew, Jesus said, "Thou hast perfected praise." In Psalm 8, it says, "Thou hast ordained strength."

The strength He ordained because of His enemies, in a perfected state, stills the enemy and the avenger.

This whole chapter is talking about Jesus being made lower than the angels for the express purpose of suffering death.

Verse 3 says:

When I consider thy heavens, the work of thy fingers, the moon and the stars, which thou
hast ordained;
What is man, that thou art mindful of him? and the son of man, that thou visitest him?
For thou hast made him a little lower than the angels, and hast crowned him with glory and
honour.

When he says, "What is man, that Thou art mindful of him? and the son of man, that Thou visitest him?" he is really saying, "Who is man, what kind of creation is this, that You are mindful of him? And who is this Son of Man with whom You visited us?"

He made Him a little lower than the angels and crowned Him with glory and honor.

I do not have to break this verse open until my meditator falls out on the ground, because Paul already broke it for me in Hebrews 2. Paul reveals that before Jesus was crowned with glory and honor, He suffered death.

Go to Hebrews 2:6:

But one in a certain place testified, saying, What is man, that thou art mindful of him?
or the son of man, that thou visitest him?
Thou madest him a little lower than the angels;
thou crownedst him with glory and honour,
and didst set him over the works of thy hands:
Thou hast put all things in subjection under his feet.

Then Paul explains the quote:

For in that he put all in subjection under him, he left nothing that is not put under him.
But now we see not yet all things put under him.
But we see Jesus, who was made a little lower than the angels for the suffering of death,
crowned with glory and honour.

Psalm 8 says He was made a little lower than the angels and crowned with glory and honor.
Hebrews tells us why: He was made a little lower than the angels for the suffering of death, then crowned with glory and honor.

Thank you, Apostle Paul, for breaking open Psalm 8.

Now back up to Hebrews 2:14-15:

Forasmuch then as the children are partakers of flesh and blood,
he also himself likewise took part of the same;
that through death he might destroy him that had the power of death, that is, the devil;
And deliver them who through fear of death were all their lifetime subject to bondage.

In Psalm 8, when he says, "Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings Thou hast ordained strength because of Thine enemies," the strength Jesus ordained is this: He was made a little lower than the angels, suffered death, destroyed the devil's hold over us, and when we were born again, we became the newborn sucklings and babes.

Those children in the temple were a type of us under the shadow. In their innocence, they lifted their hands and cried, "Hosanna! Hosanna to the King who comes in the name of the Lord! Son of David, Hosanna!"

They were a shadow of the babes and sucklings you and I would become when we were born again. The enemy is stilled by that ordained strength He gave us in the new nature. That strength is perfected when we worship and praise Him.

Old Testament saints could not perfect praise because there were not born-again babes and sucklings yet. But you and I have been born again. We received the ordained strength of the new nature that stills the enemy and can go on into perfected praise, because we can give God what He seeks: worship out of our new nature.

Those children were a type. In their innocence in the temple, how could they know the religious games? How could they know the adults were afraid? How could they know there was anything wrong?

"Do You hear what these children are saying?"

Jesus said, in effect, "Yes. Have you never read?"

Now Psalm 8 is talking about me. He has ordained strength because of my enemies. He stills the enemy. He gave me power over all the power of the enemy. He has ordained strength because of my enemies and the avenger.

When I start worshiping God, yes, sir, that is what Jesus told the Samaritan woman: "The hour now is when the true worshipers will worship Me in spirit and in truth; for the Father seeketh such to worship Him; for God is a Spirit."

Again, God is not hopping from one worship team to another looking for worshipers. It means He waited out the dispensations of four thousand years for the first men to appear on this earth with new natures. The Old Testament saints could not worship Him out of spirit because they were not born again yet. But we can.

Psalm 8 was prophesying of you and me. Jesus was made a little lower than the angels to suffer my death, destroy the power of the devil, and give us the ordained strength of the new nature. Now we can perfect praise because God is a Spirit and seeketh such to worship Him in spirit and in truth.

He ordained the strength, and that strength is perfected out of the mouths of newborn babes and sucklings when they worship Jesus. They worship Him and watch Him heal the blind and the lame, then worship Him more.

Do you want Him to come into the crowd and heal the lame and blind? Then out of the mouths of babes and sucklings, the enemy is stilled.

Worship Him. Worship Him.

We are talking about all your enemies: disease, poverty, and every other enemy. Take the strength He ordained and let it be perfected in your life.

The children were the shadow. You are the real babe. You are the real suckling. That is where praise begins its journey to perfection, because you have been restored to fellowship with the heart of the Father.

You now have the capacity for perfected praise.